important finds led him to observe that the meter(s) of the compositions on the *ex situ* slabs was "not clear, but it seems not to contradict the *mutaqārib* or the *mujtathth* of the text preserved *in situ*." Allegranzi's recent and extremely meticulous study of the dado slabs provided a modified understanding of the composition and contents of their inscriptions, as well as a period of composition probably post-mid-eleventh century, both of which are followed here. Cf. also Allegranzi 2020a; and *infra*. For the slabs carrying the *mutaqārib* meter, see Allegranzi 2019a, vol. I:70–84, 105–112, 120 and II:19–48, 64–76, 167–170, 173, 175–176, 183–192, 195–196, 204–207, 210–211, 213–216, 219. Cited here (and in note *infra*) are all the dado fragments bearing a discernible meter, whether found *in situ* or recovered *ex situ* – including at locales outside the Ghazna palace but in the city's environs, some having also been repurposed in other, usually funerary contexts (see, e.g., Laviola 2015).

24. Allegranzi's (2019a, vol. I:119–120; II:29) analysis of several dado slabs *in situ* along the central court's west perimeter noted elegiac content, with reminiscences of the poet Farrūkhī's (d. 1037–8?) compositions on the occasion of Sulṭān Maḥmūd's death. It is noteworthy, perhaps, that the simple and direct title of *shāh* is nowhere else associated with Sulṭān Maḥmūd, absent among other known numismatic and historical data; by contrast, it *was* associated with the Shansabānī Sultan Muʿīzz al-Dīn on an undated coin minted at Ghazna (cf. Giunta and Bresc 2004: 166–168, 178, 206–208, 226).
25. Although very few certainties as to personages and dates emerge from the epigraphy of the Ghazna palace dadoes, the mention of Abū Saʿīd (Sulṭān Masʿūd I) and his posthumous title of *Amīr-i Shahīd* in the following distich is among the few "incontestable" data, interpreted by Allegranzi (2019a, vol. I:120, 126 and II:36–37) as a definitive *terminus post quem* for the epigraphic project, *viz*. 1041 CE or the death of Masʿūd I. See also Giunta and Bresc 2004: 168, 177, 208.
26. Cf. esp. Allegranzi 2019a, vol. I:114–115 and II:19–51, 61–63, 80–81, 83–84, 88–90, 92–96, 117, 123–124, 132–134, 159–160, 171–172, 193–195, 200–203, 217–218, 227–228, 233–235. The reader is referred to Allegranzi's study for the contents of the epigraphic fragments; again, only those lengthy enough to convey meter are cited here (also noted *supra*).
27. A few of these fragments were photographed *in situ* during the Italian excavations of the site in the 1950s–1960s. See Figures 5.6 and 5.7.
28. Not only were these Qur'anic verses extremely common in funerary inscriptions), they are the only attested Qur'anic epigraphy in baked brick, which has been dated to the Shansabānī occupation of the Ghazna palace in the last quarter of the twelfth century. Cf. Giunta 2010a: 126; and Chapters 5 and 6.
29. While the *laqab* was primarily associated with Sulṭān Muʿīzz al-Dīn after his Ghazna victory (AH 568/1173–1174 CE) in numismatic, epigraphic, and textual sources, it was also to be seen on several coins of Maḥmūd ibn Ghīyāth al-Dīn (r. AH 602–607/1206–1210 CE [Khwārazm-shāh vassal AH 604/1207–1208 CE]); and on coins of three of the Shansabānī sulṭāns of Bamiyan. Cf. Giunta and Bresc 2004: 225.